



Learning Space

IAS MAINS 2020

VALUE ADDITION

GS - I

GS - II

GS - III

GS - IV

12 QUESTIONS WITH MODEL ANSWERS

MODULE - 6



GS – I ... HISTORY, HERITAGE & CULTURE

- 1 Examine the transformation of “global energy market” during the previous decade. What are its implications on India? (150 Words)
- 2 “The foundations for modern India were not laid in 1947, but started evolving gradually with the vision of the nationalist leaders since early 20th century”. Do you agree? Give reasoned arguments. (250 Words)
- 3 “Though India inherited a ruined economy from the British, the foundations laid by the British in political and administrative unification of India cannot be underestimated”. Discuss. (250 Words)

GS – II ... CONSTITUTION & POLITY

7

Free and Fair Elections are not just about making “mere choices”, but more about making “informed choices”. How far are the present Government policies aligned towards this end? (250 Words)

8

The Indian Constitution has “inbuilt bias towards fundamental rights” than the set of duties expected from the citizens. Do you agree with the statement? Give reasoned arguments supporting your point of view. (150 Words)

9

Critics say that the Government’s decision of carving out two Union Territories by dismantling the State of J&K strikes at the basic trait of federalism of Indian Constitution. Others see this development as a one-off measure. Give supportive arguments for both the versions. (250 Words)

GS – III ... SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

- 1 What is IndiGen project? How does it benefit India? Why can't we take the Genome Sequencing data directly from Western countries, instead of doing it on our own? (150 Words)
- 2 What do you understand by Deep Tech? Explain with examples. Can the success of Indian software sector be replicated to become global leader in Deep Tech? Argue. (250 Words)
- 3 What do you understand by "Blue Sky Research"? From Indian context, what should be the domains in focus for "Blue Sky Research". Examine the case for funding by the Government for "Blue Sky Research". (150 Words)

GS – IV ...ETHICS & INTEGRITY

16

Discuss the consequences of ethics in human action. (150 Words)

17

What are human values? Discuss the role of civil servants in building human values. (150 Words)

18

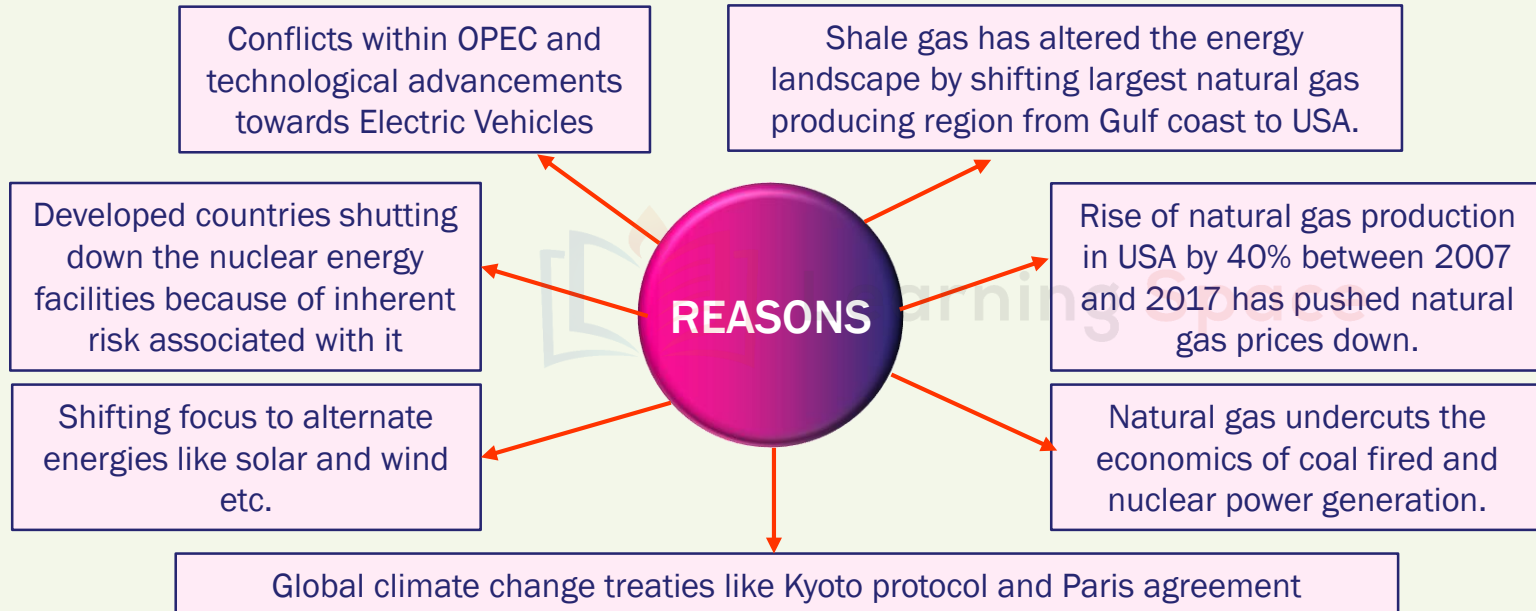
Discuss the philosophical basis of governance and welfare. (150 Words)



**Examine the transformation of “global energy market” during the previous decade.
What are its implications on India? (150 Words)**

Previous decade has witnessed telling events like shale gas revolution, global imperative to limit climate change and foster sustainable growth. This has structurally transformed global energy market.

REASONS FOR STRUCTURAL TRANSFORMATION



IMPLICATIONS ON INDIA

- Diversifying the sources of energy by shifting to USA and Shale gas because of increasing dependence of crude oil.
- Interference of USA in energy policies of India
 - ✓ E.g.: Sanctions on Iran and restricting oil import.
- Energy security of India becomes more vulnerable as domestic production of crude is reducing and imports are increasing.

THE WAY AHEAD

Diversifying the energy sources is a right step towards achieving energy security. India should enhance its focus on

- ✓ Shifting to renewable energies.
- ✓ Securing strategic petroleum reserves.
- ✓ Increasing domestic exploration of energy in collaboration with Private sector.

“The foundations for modern India were not laid in 1947, but started evolving gradually with the vision of the nationalist leaders since early 20th century”. Do you agree? Give reasoned arguments. (250 Words)

Foundations of modern India in terms of cultural unity, social progress, economic development and political awareness were laid in early 20th century. These foundations were backed by the gains of introducing English and Socio-religious reform movements.

FOUNDATIONS OF MODERN INDIA

CULTURAL UNITY

- Festivals as means to propagate nationalism by the likes of Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Bipin Chandra Pal.
- Social unity against the common problem of British evangelical attacks on Indian tradition.

SOCIAL PROGRESS

- Reinforcing the gains made during socio-religious reform movements by reformers like Narayan guru, Jothiba Phule.
- Temple entry movement and attempts to uplift Dalits by Gandhi etc.
- Awareness among backward sections by forming Schedule Castes Federation (SCF) and Dalit literature like Mook Nayak by Dr. B.R. Ambedkar.



ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

- Impetus to domestic industries during Swadeshi movement, Home rule etc.
- Estimation of poverty in economy started.
- National planning committee to plan resource distribution was established by Subash Chandra Bose.
- Various plans like Bombay plan, Sarvodaya movement etc. for economic future of the nation

POLITICAL AWARENESS

- British education and press resulted in the spread of ideals of freedom, equality, democracy etc.
- Railways and roadways united Indian society by spreading nationalism.
- Administrative and political unification reinforced nationalism tendencies.

IN A NUTSHELL

All these major developments gradually evolved to culminate in creation of a democratic, socialist, secular republic with ideals of justice, equality, liberty firmly etched in it.

“Though India inherited a ruined economy from the British, the foundations laid by the British in political and administrative unification of India cannot be underestimated”. Discuss. (250 Words)

India under British administration had become worse in multiple spheres. However, the pursuit to develop British economy on the ruins of Indian economy inadvertently resulted in progressive changes like administrative and political unification in India.

INDIAN ECONOMY AT THE TIME OF INDEPENDENCE

- Literacy rate was just 12%.
- Poverty rate was at 70%.
- Agriculture sector was saddled with surplus labour and low productivity.
- Poor irrigation facilities.
- Lack of capital goods industries.
- Industrial sector deprived of modernization, diversification and capacity building.
- Foreign trade policies in favour of British industrial revolution.

UNINTENDED BENEFITS ACCRUED TO INDIA

- Administrative unification of India by forming presidencies, commissioner provinces.
- Establishing uniform administrative structure across India like Imperial Civil Service and Indian Imperial Police etc.
- Uniform laws across country based on IPC, CrPC etc. and dedicated judicial structure for civil and criminal offences.
 - ✓ This resulted in replacing of khap panchayats and consequent prevention of adverse effects of customary laws.
- Transport connectivity through railways and roadways
 - ✓ Intended to provide export of raw material from India and market for finished goods from Britain.
- Establishment of communication system through telegraph.
 - ✓ Intended for quick mobilization of troops to stifle protests against British rule.

CONCLUSION

Though the benefits to India are unintended, the foundations of these developmental changes were laid. However, it is the efforts of Post independent Indian leadership that addressed the issues of infrastructure facilities including the framed railway network which is in need of upgradation, expansion and public orientation.



Free and Fair Elections are not just about making “mere choices”, but more about making “informed choices”. How far are the present Government policies aligned towards this end? (250 Words)

Informed choices influence the voter's attitude by shifting the basis from emotions and sentiments to rational analysis. They are inherent traits of free and fair elections to realise a mature, representative democracy.

GOVERNMENT POLICIES TOWARDS INFORMED CHOICE

TOWARDS TRANSPARENCY

Contesting candidates to produce affidavits regarding their assets and criminal records, if any

Citizen charter as part of good governance

Proposed Transparency of rules act to end any asymmetry of information regarding rules and regulations.

INFORMED CHOICE

OPACITY IN GOVERNANCE

Anonymity in political funding

Introducing electoral bonds, though reduces black money in political funding, further formalized opacity

No requirement to disclose contributions by cheque or through digital means up to Rs. 20,000



TOWARDS TRANSPARENCY

Enabling social audit in Government schemes like MGNREGA

Right to information enabled rights-based approach towards citizen's access to information

OPACITY IN GOVERNANCE

Amendment to FCRA to exempt scrutiny of foreign funds received by political parties retrospectively from 1976.

Limit on election expenditure of candidates but not political parties

Digital divide across rural-urban and gender further hampers access to information

Institutions like political parties are not yet under RTI

INFORMED CHOICE

THE WAY AHEAD

The State has to take cue from Kerala's internet highway and establish internet as a fundamental human right to enable access to information on the government policies and performance. Electoral reforms in curbing the opacity in political funding and creating awareness among civil society about their rights is necessary.

The Indian Constitution has “inbuilt bias towards fundamental rights” than the set of duties expected from the citizens. Do you agree with the statement? Give reasoned arguments supporting your point of view. (150 Words)

While fundamental rights in Part III of Constitution ensure political democracy and basic human rights, fundamental duties in Part IV-A of Constitution mandate the moral obligations of citizens towards the State.

INBUILT BIAS TOWARDS FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS

FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS

ENACTMENT

1. Enshrined in Constitution since beginning

BASIC STRUCTURE

2. Most are part of Basic Structure

PROTECTION

3. Protected by writs, in case of abuse of rights (justiciable)

PENALTY

4. Punishment for abuse of rights under IPC and CrPC and other laws

COVERAGE

5. Comprehensively covers most of the rights

FUNDAMENTAL DUTIES

1. Introduced through 42nd CAA in 1976 based on the recommendation of Swaran Singh Committee

2. Not part of Basic Structure

3. No protection against non-performance of duties by citizens (non-justiciable)

4. No laws to punish the deviants

5. Doesn't include duties to pay taxes, to vote etc.

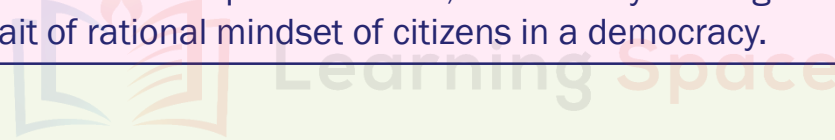


REASONS

- Democracy is based on concept of state for people and not people for state.
- Though duties are equally important, rights are necessary for a dignified life for an individual.

CONCLUSION

It is the wisdom of Constitutional makers that citizens are wise enough to perform their duties and thus a specific provision for duties is not required. Further, consciously abiding to the duties should be the trait of rational mindset of citizens in a democracy.



Critics say that the Government's decision of carving out two Union Territories by dismantling the State of J&K strikes at the basic trait of federalism of Indian Constitution. Others see this development as a one-off measure. Give supportive arguments for both the versions. (250 Words)

Jammu and Kashmir became the first state to be downgraded to Union Territory (UT) post bifurcation. The modus operandi followed in providing UT status raised apprehensions against preserving Indian federal principles.

APPREHENSIONS AGAINST INDIAN FEDERALISM

1. Whether power conferred to Parliament under Article 3 includes power to convert entire state into an UT.
 - It impacts the statehood of all other 28 states. If all 28 states are converted to UTs, the federalism, which is a part of basic structure of constitution, is at stake.
 - It is against Article 1, which emphasizes that Indian is a union of states.
2. Whether President's rule (which is temporary for 6 months) can make permanent changes that adversely affects federalism.
3. Evading compulsory referral to states for its views under Article 3 before altering its status.



VIEWING IT AS A ONE-OFF MEASURE

Jammu and Kashmir enjoyed special autonomy under Article 370 and Article 35A till the special autonomy is revoked. It remained as:

- an issue of sovereignty
- vulnerable region for terror threats
- less developed despite huge tourism potential
- a region requiring socio-economic transformation

Considering the above reasons, converting Statehood of Jammu and Kashmir to UT can be seen as an exception relative to other states.

CONCLUSION

Supreme Court, through judicial activism, should rise to protect Indian federalism. But Jammu and Kashmir can be a valid exception in Indian federal relations from the perspective of preserving nation's unity and integrity.

What is IndiGen project? How does it benefit India? Why can't we take the Genome Sequencing data directly from Western countries, instead of doing it on our own?
(150 Words)

IndiGen is a Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) initiative to undertake whole genome sequencing of thousands of individuals representing diverse ethnic groups from India.

BENEFITS TO INDIA

- Enables genetic epidemiology specific to India.
- Promotes public health technology applications using population genome data.
- Enhances scalability of genome sequencing and computational analysis at population scale in defined timeline.
- Major driver for global biomedical science.
- Predictive and preventive medicine.
- Faster and efficient diagnosis of rare and genetic tests.
- Develops indigenous capacity to generate, maintain, analyze and communicate large scale genome data.
- Prevents adverse drug reactions and analyze individuals who are insensitive to certain drugs.

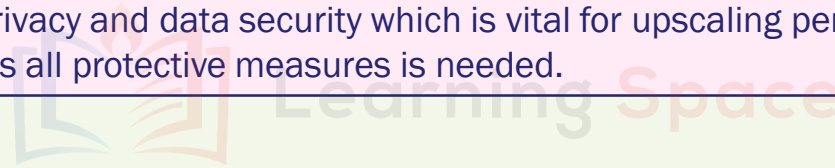


NEED FOR DEVELOPING OWN DATA

- Ensures that the huge human diversity of India is adequately represented in genome data.
- Genetic traits that are specific to India because of evolution to distinct geographical conditions are captured.
- Advances capacity to utilize the data for quality health services to people.

CONCLUSION

IndiGenome card and app ensures privacy and data security which is vital for upscaling personal genomics. Policy making that includes all protective measures is needed.



What do you understand by Deep Tech? Explain with examples. Can the success of Indian software sector be replicated to become global leader in Deep Tech? Argue. (250 Words)

Deep technologies are transformative technologies built on tangible scientific discoveries and engineering innovations. They catalyse solutions to big issues that affect society.

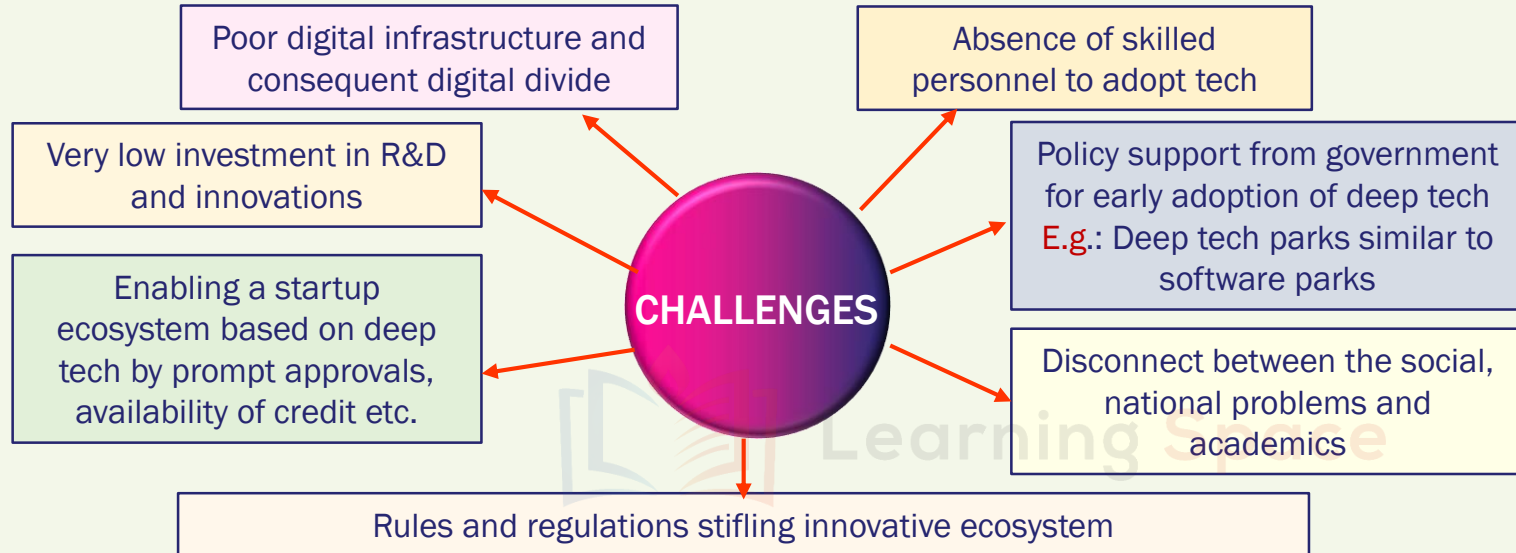
E.g.:

- ✓ New medical device or technique fighting cancer
- ✓ Data analytics to help farmers grow more food
- ✓ Clean energy solutions to lessen human impact on climate change

- The deep technology companies possess fundamental and defensible engineering innovations like flying cars that distinguish them from those companies based on incremental refinement or business model innovation like Uber, Swiggy etc.
- They span across technological areas like power electronics, machine learning, vision and speech algorithms etc.

DEEP TECH IN INDIA

To emulate the success of Indian software sector, the following challenges are to be addressed:



WAY AHEAD

Success of Indian software sector is a collaborative effort of state, academics, and private enterprise. Such collaboration to adopt deep tech is needed in addressing these challenges.

What do you understand by “Blue Sky Research”? From Indian context, what should be the domains in focus for “Blue Sky Research”. Examine the case for funding by the Government for “Blue Sky Research”. (150 Words)

Blue Sky Research is an exploratory research driven by curiosity without a clear goal. Researchers aim to understand the world around and analyze interesting and applicable surprises along the way. It is the research into today's unknown.

BLUE SKY RESEARCH – INDIAN CONTEXT

Various domains that need focus are

- Quantum computing
- Neural networks
- Geo-engineering
- Genomics
- Dark energy
- Alternative energies
- Electric Vehicles



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CASE FOR GOVERNMENT FUNDING

- Private sector investments seek time-based returns.
- Private sector is more interested in applied research.
- Government funding helps researchers invest time in Blue Sky research.
- Blue Sky research in social sciences can lead to roots of social problems and help in policy making.
- India's R&D expenditure is abysmally low at 0.7% of GDP and only 0.23% college graduates pursue research in contrast to 1% in USA and China.

THE WAY FORWARD

Initiatives like National mission on cyber physical systems, and quantum computing are steps ahead. India needs to push for more Blue Sky projects to realize the maximum potential of technologies to solve social problems.



Discuss the consequences of ethics in human action. (150 Words)

Ethics are set of principles that guide human actions in a way acceptable to the society. The consequences of enabling ethics in human actions can be analyzed at three levels.

1. INDIVIDUAL LEVEL

- **Brings credibility to the individual**
 - ✓ **E.g.:** Despite lower cost proposal from company X, if Mr. A abides to his contract made with company Y, his standing as a credible businessman goes up. This will increase his business prospects.
- **Builds self confidence**
 - ✓ Power of doing the right thing makes a person fearless
 - ✓ **E.g.:** An ethical officer can stand against unfounded corrupt charges against him/her boldly. Often people's support is with such officers.
- **Builds social capital**
 - ✓ It helps an ethical individual to get support at the time of crisis.

2. ORGANISATIONAL LEVEL

- Enhances brand equity/image of the organization.
 - ✓ **E.g.:** People's trust in Indian democracy prevailed because of the free and fair elections conducted by election commission.
- Strengthens employee-employer relationship.
- Garner support from all stock holders.

3. SOCIETAL LEVEL

- Absence of greed and consequent equitable resource distribution.
- Enables peace in society.
- Ideals of equality, justice and fraternity prevails.

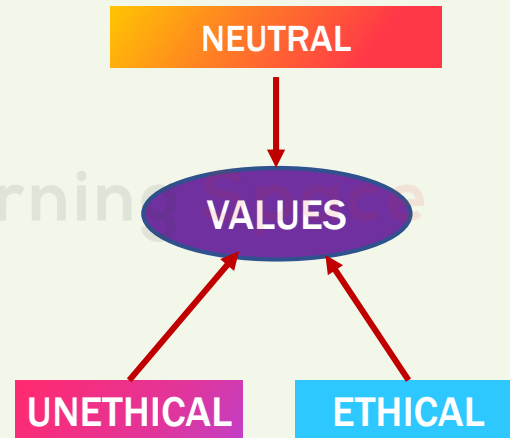
CONCLUSION

Strong value-based education starting from family, schools and peer group is necessary for realizing such consequences at all levels.

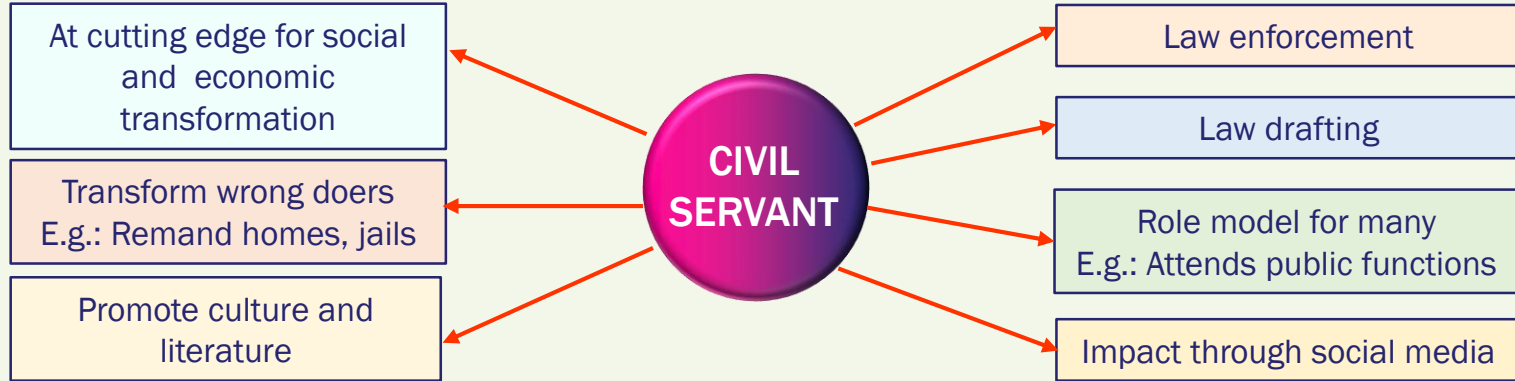
**What are human values? Discuss the role of civil servants in building human values.
(150 Words)**

Values imply preferences. One's preferences become one's values. If a society as a whole prefers something, it becomes a societal value. Values can be ethical, unethical or ethically neutral.

- A Value become ethical if
 - ✓ it is approved by the society.
 - ✓ it doesn't harm anyone.
- At societal level, to ensure ethical values,
 - ✓ Wrong values should invite punitive sanctions.
 - ✓ Right values must invite positive sanctions (i.e., being treated with respect).



ROLE OF CIVIL SERVANTS IN BUILDING VALUES



Civil servants have a vast scope of influencing the citizenry in general and youngsters in specific to transform to ethical individuals.

FINALLY

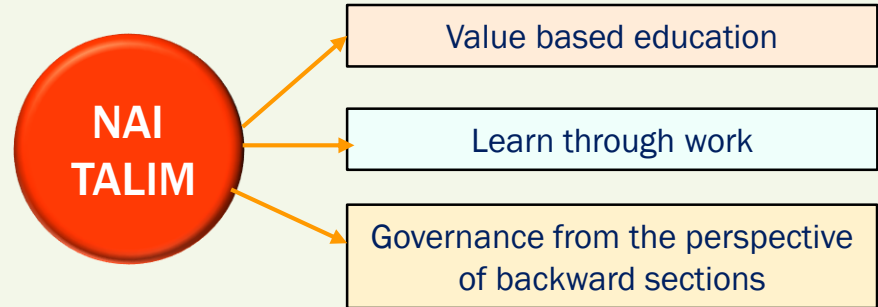
Enabling human values among civil servants results in ethical governance. This inculcation of human values should also be the moral imperative of civil society, and state to start inculcating ethical values at family and schools since early childhood.

Discuss the philosophical basis of governance and welfare. (150 Words)

Philosophical basis for governance and welfare is found in the writings of philosophers and political thinkers. Mahatma Gandhi's Nai Talim and Kautilya's discourse on governance along with views on governance of Socrates and Plato play major influence.

1. NAI TALIM

- According to Gandhi, when one faces a dilemma in decision making, one should remember the poorest man one has ever seen and then take the decision that can positively impact such an individual.
- It calls for policy making that is in favour of empowering the poor.



2. KAUTILYA

- King's interests should lie in the interests of his people. In the welfare and happiness of his subjects lies the king's happiness.

3. SOCRATES

- All laws should be formulated to promote justice.
- Unconditional abiding to law by all citizens is the cardinal principle of governance.

CONCLUSION

It is the wisdom of a nation to adopt best governance practice in enhancing the welfare. These philosophies of governance should be used by the nations to guide them towards welfare based inclusive and sustainable development.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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